



both financially and economically. Equally important is climate. If I can't predict the weather, how am I going to get 1.5 degrees of mitigation?

Q: You first visited India in 1992. What do you like about what you see today?

A: I think there are two things that we have to think about. As a country, you have much more interaction and involvement in the global economies than what it was 30 years ago. Then, it was domestic-focussed and today, the world is seeing India as a much bigger opportunity. The discussion today is about how this country can become a bigger asset to the rest of the world in areas such as supply chain. And clearly, infrastructure has changed tremendously and a lot more needs to be done.

If you go to the financial side of the equation, the amount of FDI or trade has seen a huge leap. In 10-20 years from now, you have the potential to be right up there with the US and China. So, that is a huge flip. In order for it to secure that place in the world, you need to have trust in the society that you're interacting with, plus trust in the government policies that have been put

ON A WORLD IN FLUX

The world is going through some seismic shifts in terms of the demographics changing—both in terms of size and the rise of the lower and middle classes. You see a polarisation of the world as the haves and the have-nots, from a political and economic perspective. You see the implications of tech and climate, plus a combination of this changing the labour force

ON CAPITAL MARKETS AND CAPITALISM

Today, we talk about global capital markets and capitalism being dead. No, it's not dead. We need each other more than ever before. It has just got a different way of rewiring itself

ON ECONOMIC PHILOSOPHIES

In today's environment with zero interest rates or even negative interest rates, a fully employed labour force in some countries or a potential recession, a lot of economic philosophy may be relevant but not absolute

forth. It is the trust that you will do things the right way and trust in the numbers—both financial and non-financial—that people will rely on to make a decision on investing.

I like the labour force that has been created and also the digital assets and the digitisation of the economy that is being leveraged. Those two things are super important to the future of this economy. Now, there are two things that are yet to come. One is the climate aspect and the other is, how will the infrastructure continue to be built out?

Q: Much has been said about China and about China-plus one. What is your view?

A: First, in the case of China, you had a country that developed very, very fast, and had a huge impact on the world and took a role that some would argue is equal to a leading country like the US. And in doing so, it created alternatives. Other than the US from a dependency perspective, it did that by enhancing the growth in the local domestic economy that's creating 20-30 million new jobs a year.

Now the difference between China and India is that in the case of China, you had uniformity relevant to how government and business interacted. In India, you've got the federal-like level and the state-like level and not as much alignment as necessary to drive that speed, certainty and scalability. Having said that, where India now has a big advantage is that it is seen as that second source or that third source. If it delivers an affordable supply chain, manufacturing and goods and services and labour—if all this can be delivered in a climate-friendly way with the right digitisation and the right data connection points, people will see that as a benefit [to the world].

Q: There is a lot going on around ESG. But it is also a situation where one has to deal with the conflicting objective of meeting current energy requirements. It is a difficult situation to be in...

A: Not necessarily. We have a slowing economy and institutions need to survive the next two to three years to thrive in the